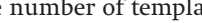


7.2 The Look

Start up FrontPage and take a look at the layout of all the tools and menus. Like we said before, if you've used any other MS Office applications, you will find FrontPage really easy to use.



FrontPage will start with a blank page by default, and if all you're going to do is build a single page for yourself, you can start right away. However, the power of FrontPage lies in the number of templates and presets it offers you, so you don't have to learn everything from scratch.

A screenshot of the Microsoft FrontPage application window. The title bar reads "FrontPage - Blank Page". The main workspace shows a blank white area with a faint grid pattern. On the left side, there is a vertical toolbar with various icons for creating and editing web pages. At the bottom, a status bar displays "Blank Page" and "1 KB".

FrontPage looks similar to most other MS Office applications, so you should feel right at home

Let's first look at the layout of the software. Starting on the top left, you will see the standard toolbar that all of us Windows users have become accustomed to. The familiar File, Edit, View and other menus are there, along with the regular text formatting tools from MS Word.



The FrontPage tool and menus

Next, you will notice that the page below is broken into two panes—the top one will have code in it and the bottom will be blank. This is the Split view that has made FrontPage so popular, and is now a standard way of creating HTML Web pages in most Web design software. The bottom pane lets you design and format your Web site in a WYSIWYG environment. Don't worry, that large acronym doesn't mean anything absurdly technical—it just stands for “what you see is what you get.”